Definition



Learning disabilities are disorders that affects one's ability to understand or use spoken or written language, do mathematical calculations or direct attention.

Causes

The causes for learning disabilities are not well understood, and sometimes there is no apparent cause for a learning disability. However, some causes of neurological impairments include:

- ***Heredity and genetics:*** Learning disabilities often run in the family.
- ***Problems during pregnancy and birth:*** Malnutrition Anomalies in the developing brain, illness or injury, fetal exposure to alcohol or drugs.
- ***Accidents after birth:*** Head injuries, Malnutrition, Toxic exposure to heavy metals

Characteristics of Learning Disability:

- Slow reading rate
- Difficulty in recalling
- Difficulty in finding
- Confusion
- Problems with reasonings

Types of Learning Disabilities

A. Dyscalculia



This is a type of learning disability, where the children have difficulty in math fact. They have poor understanding of math symbols, numbers and feel difficulty in counting the numbers.

Management: Allow use of fingers, use diagrams and provide peer assistance. Also use mnemonic devices and schedule time for practice.

B. Dysgraphia

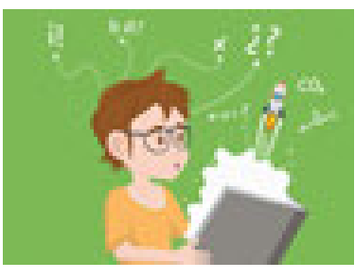


Type of learning disability that affects children handwriting ability and fine motor activity. It may be illegible handwriting, spelling mistakes, spatial problem in paper.

Management

- Conduct oral exams. Provide notes to decrease writing.
- Allow to use ruled paper and graph paper.

C. Dyslexia



A learning disability that affects reading and related skill. This also known as language based learning disability. It may affect fluency, recall, writing, spelling and sometimes speech.

The student may read slowly, trouble in spelling, cannot exhibit recalling words. May feel difficulty in handwriting.

Treatment:

- Intensive teaching techniques
- Improve both spoken and written language skills
- Classroom modification

Management

Provide calm area for study. Provide copy of notes, small unit of lessons, large print books. Do not count the spelling in tests.

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